

MEDICINE

AIIMS, Delhi, reigns supreme while the Armed Forces Medical College, Pune, moves a notch up. Madras Medical College finds a place in the hall of fame.

■ By Shruti Maheshwari

No surprises here. The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) continues its monopoly over the top slot in the field of medicine, as it has for the past five years. This, despite a controversy over leadership and a residents' strike on reservation. AIIMS faces stiff competition from The Armed Forces Medical College (AFMC), Pune, has moved up to the number two position this year displacing Christian Medical College (CMC), Vellore. The other institute that has held fort at number four is the Jawaharlal Institute of Postgraduate Medical Education and Research (JIPMER), Puducherry.

So deep is the reverence for this year's top ranker that the Government has announced the setting up of six more AIIMS or AIIMS-like institutions around the country. With stress on the in-house residency programme and super-speciality courses like its Doctor of Medicine and Master

of Chirurgery (or Surgery), AIIMS produces around 1,400 research papers annually—more than 50 per cent of the total number of papers that all the other Indian medical institutions, put together, produce. Many of these are published in reputed national and international medical journals with high-impact factor.

Being a referral centre, AIIMS has to attend to 30 lakh outpatients annually, conduct 1.8 lakh operations and treat 1.35 lakh patients. The work load and strained resources do not impact the quality of patient care and hospital performance indicators are comparable to the best in the world. "This itself is enough to tell you about the kind of motivation of our staff members," says Dr A.K. Bisoi, a professor of cardiothoracic surgery.

Explains Director P. Venugopal: "The super-specialists, medical and paramedical graduates, trained at AIIMS carry a culture of zeal to excel in their respective fields and are the cynosure of any medical establish-

TOP 10 COLLEGES

2007		2006
1	AIIMS, Delhi	1
2	Armed Forces Medical College, Pune	3
3	Christian Medical College, Vellore	2
4	JIPMER, Puducherry	4
5	Kasturba Medical College, Manipal	6
6	Lady Hardinge Medical College, Delhi	5
7	Maulana Azad Medical College, Delhi	7
8	Grant Medical College, Mumbai	8
9	St. John's Medical College, Bangalore	9
10	Madras Medical College, Chennai	-

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores. Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked.
* New entrants in Top 10. (—) Not ranked in the 2006 Top 20.

AIMING HIGH:
Medicos in
an AIIMS
laboratory



BANDEEP SINGH